

Swiss Grounding MCP

Reliable Swiss answers for AI assistants: the myAI challenge at the Swiss AI Weeks Zurich Hackathon

Hacker Q&A, 16.09.2026, updated 21.09.2026 | Matthias Appius and Alexander Stark, Swisscom myAI



Authoritative Swiss sources come first | give the assistant a tool that reaches them instead of trusting whatever a web search returns

Where the sources are

1

Federal government

Laws, taxes, statistics, national services

2

Cantons

Tax rules, schools, permits, social services

3

Municipalities

Fees, waste collection, registration, opening hours

4

Institutions close to government

Semi official bodies whose information is authoritative too

What happens today

1

The assistant runs a web search

That is a good grounding tool when the information is online

2

Search does not know authority

It ranks pages, it cannot tell an official source from a summary or a foreign site

3

The answer is sometimes wrong

And the user notices, because the correct answer is a matter of record

What we want

1

A tool the model can call

So it reaches the authoritative Swiss source first instead of following search blindly

2

Across the whole spectrum

Taxes, health insurance, law, waste collection, permits, transport and more

3

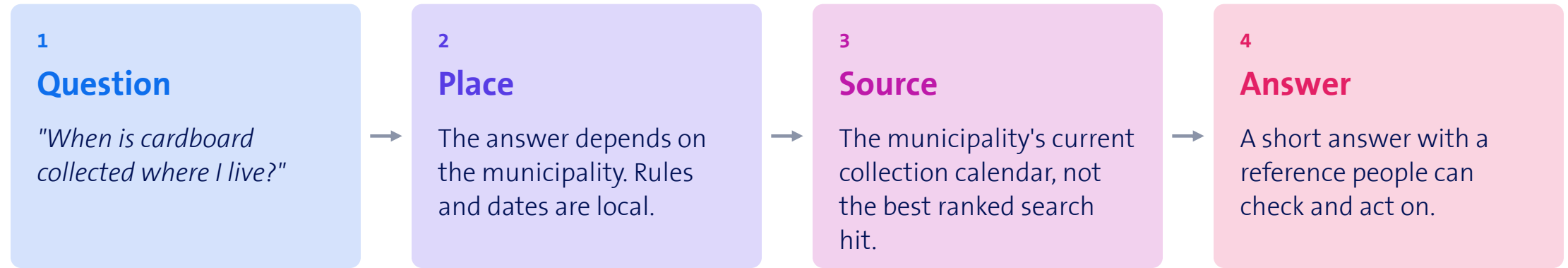
Any approach that works

Curated sources, a search layer that knows Swiss authority, APIs, indexes or a mix



Swiss questions need Swiss sources | one example of how a grounded answer comes together, and where web search alone falls short

EXAMPLE, ONE OF MANY POSSIBLE QUESTIONS



Why web search alone is not enough

Tools ground an LLM, and web search is a good one when the information is online. It still fails in typical ways:

Wrong jurisdiction

The answer differs by canton or municipality. Search returns whichever page ranks best.

Outdated information

An old page outranks the current one, or the value changed recently.

Invisible data

The answer sits in an API, a dataset table or a PDF annex that search does not surface.

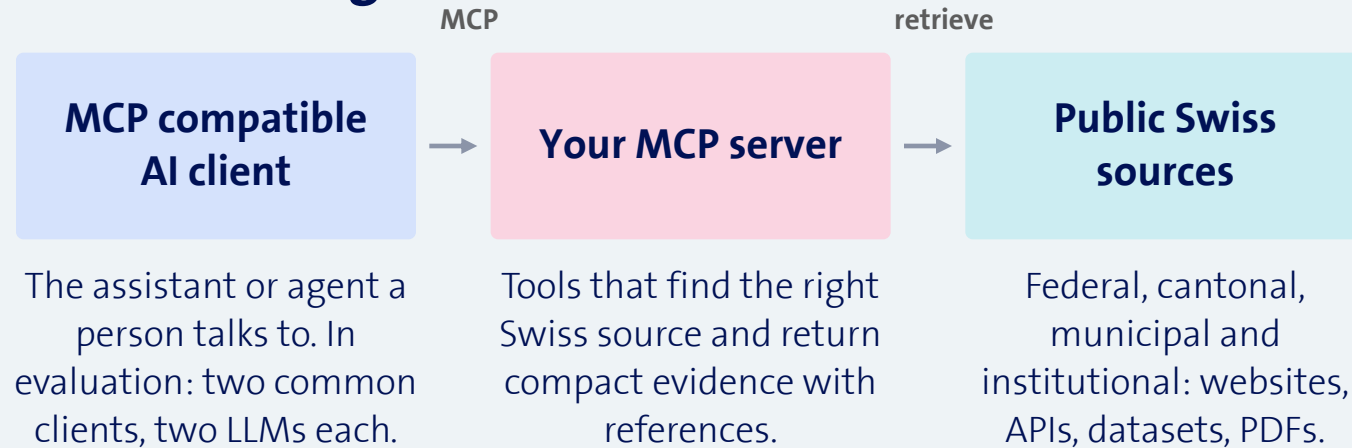
Foreign confusion

A German, Austrian, French or Italian source looks authoritative but does not apply in Switzerland.



Build a focused Swiss Grounding MCP server | you choose the topic, the sources and the method, and MCP is the shared interface

How it fits together



EXAMPLE SOURCE CATEGORIES, YOUR CHOICE

Municipal calendars

Public transport

Permits

Fees

Statistics

Administrative information

POSSIBLE METHODS, ALONE OR COMBINED

APIs

Crawling

Indexing

Retrieval

Caching

Scheduled refresh

Live fetching

What a good MCP does

- Offers a coherent, compact set of tools
- Returns evidence an AI client can use and cite
- Keeps information as fresh as the use case needs
- Says so when a question is not covered
- Runs locally from its repo; hosting it as well is your choice

A focused solution that works well is valid. Breadth is evaluated and weighted separately.



What makes a useful submission | a working, grounded, efficient and reproducible server that Swisscom can test

1

Grounding quality

Correct, authoritative, right jurisdiction, current and cited. Honest when a question is not covered.

2

Useful Swiss coverage

Practical value, breadth and depth of the public Swiss information you make accessible.

3

Agent efficiency

Good tool selection, few calls, compact responses, low latency and no unnecessary live requests.

4

Operability and maintainability

Reproducible setup, sensible refresh and caching, resilience and source etiquette.

5

Integration readiness

Coherent MCP contract, clear documentation, extensible and usable from standard MCP clients.

What you deliver

- GitHub repository, public or private, with evaluator access
- Clear setup instructions so we can run it ourselves
- Documented coverage and limitations
- Secure test access if needed, no secrets in the repo

How Swisscom tests

- Two MCP clients, two LLMs each, same for every team
- Questions across many Swiss topics with verified answers
- Quality first, breadth weighted separately
- Automated and LLM assisted checks plus manual review
- No myAI integration needed during the event

Q&A

Your questions from the hacker Q&A on 16. September 2026, answered

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What we test, and how coverage is compared fairly | declare your scope, answer quality first, breadth evaluated and weighted separately

Declare your scope in your README: which topics and which geography you cover. We evaluate answer quality against that declaration. Breadth is evaluated and weighted separately. High quality with narrow coverage beats broad coverage with low quality. Having both is best and wins.

Quality in your scope

Correct, from an authoritative Swiss source, right jurisdiction, current, and cited.

Breadth

How much useful public Swiss information your server makes accessible.

Honesty outside scope

A few questions fall outside what you declared. Say clearly that this is not covered. Do not guess.

Asking back can be the right answer

When the answer depends on missing information, such as the municipality, a precise request for exactly that counts as correct. When the question can be answered as asked, asking back counts as wrong, and so does asking for context you do not need.



How we test | the same setup for every team, a hidden question set, no published formula

The setup, identical for every team

Client A + LLM 1

Client A + LLM 2

Client B + LLM 1

Client B + LLM 2

Two MCP compatible clients, two LLMs each. Your server is connected exactly as your setup instructions describe.

Which clients and models: not disclosed. Build against the MCP standard, not against one specific assistant.

What we tell you, and what we keep

- Published here: the topic areas and five sample questions
- Hidden: the full question set and its size
- Questions in German, French, Italian and Romansh

Assessment and order of importance

Automated checks and LLM assisted comparison against verified answers inform the Swisscom myAI review group, which decides by hand. No published formula.

- 1 **Correct and honest answers**
- 2 Breadth
- 3 Efficiency, operability, MCP contract



Which sources to use | finding and reaching authoritative Swiss sources is part of the challenge

What counts as authoritative

The body that is actually responsible: the federal office, the canton, the municipality, or an organisation with a legal mandate.

- Federal offices publish under admin.ch; ch.ch maps who is responsible for what
- Cantons publish under their own domains, usually the two letter code: be.ch, vd.ch, ti.ch, gr.ch
- Municipalities publish on their own websites; many local answers exist only there
- Some semi official bodies are authoritative because the law gives them the job
- Four national languages: a source may exist in only one or two, and the answer may depend on the region

No source list from Swisscom

Curate a registry, discover sources dynamically, query open data and APIs, or combine approaches. The evaluation does not check which sites you used. It checks whether your server reaches authoritative Swiss information and returns grounded answers with references people can verify.

robots.txt and terms of use

Respect them by default, and make it configurable. Whether your server does so must be a configuration setting, not hardcoded behaviour, so that Swisscom can switch it on or off for testing. Document the setting and its default in your README.



Example topic areas and sources | where authoritative answers live, as examples, not a required list and not the evaluation set

1 Health insurance premiums and basic insurance

priminfo.admin.ch

FEDERAL

2 Taxes and fees

Ticino tax administration, ti.ch

CANTONAL

3 Law and regulations

fedlex.admin.ch

FEDERAL

4 Waste collection and recycling

Lausanne waste calendar, lausanne.ch

MUNICIPAL

5 Moving, residence registration and civil status

City of Bern residents' office, bern.ch

MUNICIPAL

6 Residence permits and migration

sem.admin.ch

FEDERAL

7 Social insurance and pensions

ahv-iv.ch

SEMI OFFICIAL

8 Work and unemployment

arbeit.swiss

FEDERAL

9 Schools and education

Geneva education department, ge.ch

CANTONAL

10 Public transport and mobility

opentransportdata.swiss

SEMI OFFICIAL

11 Road traffic, vehicles and driving licences

Graubünden road traffic office, gr.ch

CANTONAL

12 Housing and renting

bwo.admin.ch

FEDERAL

13 Voting, elections and political rights

bk.admin.ch

FEDERAL

14 Companies, commercial register and VAT

zefix.ch

FEDERAL

15 Customs and ordering from abroad

bazg.admin.ch

FEDERAL

16 Statistics, open data, geodata and weather

bfs.admin.ch, opendata.swiss,
map.geo.admin.ch, meteoswiss.admin.ch

FEDERAL



Five sample questions | the kind of questions in the hidden set, not its content

One of them can only be answered after asking which municipality is meant. One of them is not a question about Switzerland at all, and the right response is to say so. We do not tell you which.

- 1 Wann wird bei uns das nächste Mal Karton abgeholt?
- 2 Comment puis-je échanger mon permis de conduire étranger contre un permis suisse dans le canton de Vaud, et combien de temps ai-je pour le faire?
- 3 Qual è il premio mensile più basso dell'assicurazione di base per un adulto di 30 anni domiciliato a Lugano con franchigia di 2500 franchi?
- 4 Cura èn las vacanzas d'atun 2026 per la scola da Scuol?
- 5 Wie hoch ist der Rundfunkbeitrag, den ich nach meinem Umzug nach Konstanz zahlen muss?



How your solution must run, and what support there is | hosted or local, prebuilt indexes are fine, keys are handed over securely, costs are yours

Run it locally or hosted, your choice

We test a hosted endpoint or start the server from your repository. Either way, the code in your repository must also run locally with the setup you document, so that we can confirm that the published source is the server we tested. If you host, keep the endpoint up until the evaluation is complete.

Prebuilt indexes are fine

Ship a prebuilt vector store or index with the repository, or let the setup download it from a location you provide. Two conditions: the setup fetches and uses it without manual steps, and the repository contains the script that built it. We do not rebuild your index during the evaluation.

Keys and test access

Runtime API keys are acceptable, for example for query time embeddings or an LLM call inside the server. List every credential in your README and hand working test credentials to Swisscom through the organisers' secure channel before the deadline. Never commit secrets. A key free server is easier to run, and that shows in operability.

Costs and credits

Swisscom does not reimburse API, embedding or hosting costs. The organisers mentioned API credits in the Q&A: ask them directly; confirmed details go into the repository README. Embedding budget does not decide the ranking: a small, well built index or a live API approach with no embeddings is as valid as a large vector store.